COPY · PASTE · ADAPT

1102tools MCP Prompt Guide

Federal contracting research, one useful question at a time.

Prompts for opportunities, competitors, teaming, awards, labor rates, wages, travel, regulations, and FAR Overhaul deviations. Install and connect the required MCPs in your AI client before using a prompt. Then replace the bracketed details and check the returned sources.

SAM.gov #1 MOST USED Contract opportunities, entity registrations, SBA certifications, and exclusions.	**USAspending** #2 MOST USED Contracts, grants, loans, recipients, agencies, and subawards.	**eCFR** #3 MOST USED The FAR, DFARS, and agency supplements: clause text, definitions, and what changed and when.
Acquisition.gov FAR Overhaul model text, posted agency deviations, and guidance. The only known MCP server for this source.	**GSA CALC+** Awarded labor-category ceiling rates and comparison data.	**Federal Register** Published rules, notices, comment periods, and FAR cases.
BLS OEWS Occupational wages by geography and data year from the Bureau of Labor Statistics.	**Regulations.gov** Rulemaking dockets, documents, and public comments.	**GSA Per Diem** Lodging and meals-and-incidental-expense rates by locality.

OCTOBER 2026 · 56 PROMPTS · 9 MCP SOURCES

Federal contracting prompts / MCP servers and setup

Start with the work

A prompt does not install an MCP. Install and connect every required MCP in your AI client before running a prompt. If two are listed, both are required.

1. Check the **Required MCPs** line. Each source name links to its setup instructions.
2. Configure any API keys outside chat and confirm your client can see the tools.
3. Replace the brackets, run the prompt, and check the sources and dates.

Ask for the exact source, data period, and retrieval date. Keep missing records, incomplete pages, and uncertain matches visible.

Setup and available Claude and ChatGPT installs: 1102tools.com/#mcps

Find a prompt

Combine sources 3
Find opportunities 4
Research competitors 6
Track potential recompetes 7
Vet companies and find teammates 7
Understand a market 9
Find the right codes 10
Compare labor rates 11
Research wages 12
Estimate travel 13
Read the regulations 14
Follow published changes 14
Explore dockets and comments 15
FAR Overhaul and deviations 16

October 2026 edition. Prompt wording and source mappings have been reviewed. Provider data and tool availability can change; this is not a claim that every request was re-run live.

Combine sources

Use multiple MCPs to connect award history, company records, and pricing context.

Size up a competitor

Size up [COMPANY]: use USAspending to show contract obligations over the last 24 months, top agencies, and main work. Confirm the company's name and UEI. With SAM.gov, add registration status, returned certification evidence, and exclusions. If Hosted SAM.gov is connected, report its source file dates, distinguish certification codes from detailed certification dates, and confirm current registration on SAM.gov; flag missing evidence. Finish with two sentences on strengths and exposure.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov + USAspending · Hosted SAM.gov supplies dated public registration, certification codes with any listed exit dates, and exclusions; use Local full for live API details and certification entry dates.

The graduation window

Find firms with 8(a) set-aside awards under NAICS [NAICS] in USAspending. Check each selected recipient's SBA certification dates in SAM.gov and the end dates of its relevant awards. Flag documented program exit dates within 18 months that overlap with contract end dates within 12 months. Show the dates and source records. Treat missing certification data as unresolved, not proof of graduation; treat an approaching award end as a research lead, not a confirmed recompete.
If SBA exit dates aren't available from the connected SAM.gov server, list the award-end leads and mark the 8(a) exit date as a check to do on SAM.gov.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov + USAspending · Hosted SAM.gov supplies monthly public certification codes and any listed 8(a) exit dates, and flags exit dates that have passed; confirm current certification with SBA.

Vet a teammate

Vet [COMPANY] as a teammate: check exclusions and registration expiration with SAM.gov, then use USAspending to show whether they have primed work for [AGENCY], including purchases funded there but awarded elsewhere. List other recent federal work. If Hosted SAM.gov is connected, report its source file dates and confirm current registration on SAM.gov. Flag missing evidence; opted-out entities are not included in the hosted public mirror.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov + USAspending · Hosted SAM.gov supplies dated public registration and exclusion checks; confirm current registration on SAM.gov.

Opportunity evidence screen

Build an opportunity evidence screen for [NOTICE ID]. Pull the opportunity from SAM.gov, then use USAspending to find comparable work at that agency under the same NAICS, including award sizes, end dates, and evidence of a current incumbent. Keep public facts separate from assumptions. List the internal capability, vehicle, past performance, staffing, pricing, and risk-tolerance facts we still need; do not make the company's bid/no-bid decision from public data alone.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov + USAspending

What did the government actually pay?

Find comparable federal contracts for [REQUIREMENT] under NAICS [NAICS] in USAspending, skipping ones with a different scope. For each, show how it was competed, obligations, current value, potential value with all options, and outlays (money actually paid out) where reported, naming the field behind each number, plus performance dates. Then show CALC+ ceiling rates for the matching labor categories separately. Don't turn a total award amount into an hourly rate without a documented staffing and period of performance basis.

Required MCPs: USAspending + GSA CALC+

Find opportunities

Start with the requirement, deadline, and notice. Keep amendments and incomplete searches visible.

What federal IT work is coming that isn't out for bid yet?

Using the SAM.gov tool, show me federal IT work that's coming but not out for bid yet:
- NAICS starting with 5415 (all computer and IT services)
- Only Sources Sought and Presolicitation notices
- Still open for responses

First, count them by agency so I can see who's planning the most IT buying.
Then list the most interesting ones in a table with response due date, title, agency, set-aside (if any), and sam.gov link.
Pick the 5 biggest or most strategic opportunities and say in one line each why a company should respond now.
Keep notices with no stated deadline; flag sole-source intent, and only call an opportunity big when its notice states a value.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov

Open solicitations, deadline first

Find current SAM.gov Solicitation and Combined Synopsis/Solicitation notices for NAICS [NAICS] due between today and [N] days from now. Fetch all matches, remove duplicate notice IDs, and sort by deadline. Show title, agency, deadline and time zone, set-aside, and SAM.gov link. Exclude expired deadlines. Note snapshot date, active-file coverage, missing fields, and attachment limits.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov

Sources sought and RFIs

Find sources sought notices under NAICS [NAICS] from the last 60 days, then separately search notice titles for RFI. Identify the returned notice types and flag response deadlines within two weeks. If I supply PSC [PSC], run a separate PSC search, merge the results, and deduplicate by notice ID. Identify limits or missing pages instead of treating a partial search as complete.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov

Read one opportunity properly

Retrieve opportunity [NOTICE ID] from SAM.gov, including the full description when available. Summarize the requirement, response deadline, evaluation approach if stated, and any explicit incumbent references. Cite the notice and distinguish stated requirements from your interpretation. Identify attachments or amendments the MCP did not retrieve.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov

Fresh award notices

Find contract award notices under NAICS [NAICS] posted to SAM.gov in the last [N] days. Show the winner, reported amount, award date, posting date, notice ID, and source link where available. Keep missing amounts or dates marked as missing. If few results appear, report the search coverage and offer a wider window; do not infer that no awards occurred or assume every award posts immediately.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov

One agency's postings

Find current SAM.gov notices for NAICS [NAICS] posted in the last 90 days by [AGENCY]. Show title, agency path, notice type, posting date, response deadline, and SAM.gov link, including postings with past deadlines. List the department, sub-tier, and office names matched by the agency filter; command names may miss subordinate field offices.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov

Research competitors

Confirm the recipient identity before comparing customers, awards, and subcontracting records.

Find the right recipient record

Search USAspending recipients for [COMPANY] and list every match with its lifetime award total and whether it is the parent rollup or a subsidiary record. The same company appears several times and the totals differ by a lot, so name the record you pick and use it in everything that follows. If the search returns only near-misses, try the other recipient search tool before deciding the company is not in the data.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Their last 12 months

Pull [COMPANY]'s federal contract activity over the last 12 months. For each award, show award ID, agency, NAICS, performance end date, obligations added minus removals during that window, and cumulative award obligations separately. Sort by obligations added minus removals in the window, largest first. Add "in NAICS [NAICS] only" if I want one code.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Where their money comes from

Retrieve [COMPANY]'s federal contract awards for the last two years from USAspending using the selected recipient record. Summarize obligations by awarding agency, with agency share and the underlying award count. Use compatible source filters and paginate as needed. If only a sample is retrieved, state its size and selection method and label the shares as sample shares, not the company's complete revenue concentration.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Who they sub to

Find who [COMPANY] reports subcontracting work to. Confirm its recipient identity, retrieve its ten largest contract prime awards by cumulative obligations, and search all reported subaward pages for each. List prime ID, subcontract recipient, report amount and action date. Explain that these are the company's subcontractors, not primes it works under, and that absent reports do not establish self-performance.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Track potential recompetes

Award end dates identify research leads. They do not guarantee a new solicitation.

An agency's expiring contracts

Find [AGENCY]'s contract awards under NAICS [NAICS] above $[FLOOR] with recorded performance end dates in the next nine months. Use USAspending's available filters and paginate through the results; if end dates require local filtering, explain the coverage. Flag implausible dates, possible follow-on awards, and option-period uncertainty. Present the results as potential recompete leads, not confirmed future solicitations.

Required MCPs: USAspending

When a company's contracts end

List [COMPANY]'s USAspending contract awards with recorded performance end dates between today and [N] months from now. Sort the selected results by end date and report the recipient identity, award ID, agency, amount field, and end date. If the tool cannot filter directly by end date, paginate and filter the retrieved records. State incomplete coverage and distinguish award end dates from confirmed recompete plans.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Vet companies and find teammates

Use entity identifiers, registration records, and supporting evidence to build a useful shortlist.

Exclusion check

Check whether [COMPANY / UEI] has any exclusion records. If records exist, tell me whether any are currently active and what they are for.
If Hosted SAM.gov is connected, report the source file name and date. Entity records are monthly snapshots; opted-out entities are not included in the hosted public mirror. Confirm current registration and material exclusion findings on SAM.gov before relying on them.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov · Hosted SAM.gov supplies dated public exclusion records; verify current findings on SAM.gov.

Registration status at a glance

Look up [COMPANY] in SAM.gov and tell me: is the registration active, when does it expire, what is its primary NAICS, and what socioeconomic categories does it hold? If more than 1 active registration exists, say how many and name the UEI you picked before answering.
Do not infer corporate ownership from a shared address alone.
If Hosted SAM.gov is connected, report the source file name and date. Entity records are monthly snapshots; opted-out entities are not included in the hosted public mirror. Confirm current registration and material exclusion findings on SAM.gov before relying on them.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov · Hosted SAM.gov supplies monthly public registration records and certification codes; confirm current registration on SAM.gov.

SBA certification dates

Retrieve [COMPANY]'s SBA certification fields from its SAM.gov entity record. Report each listed program, status, entry date, and exit date using the source's own labels. Distinguish a documented date from an inferred current status. An empty certification list or a historical set-aside award does not by itself prove present eligibility, graduation, or ineligibility.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov · Hosted SAM.gov shows certification codes and any listed exit dates; entry dates and live status need the Local full SAM.gov edition.

Registration, exclusion, and integrity evidence

For [UEI], retrieve the current SAM.gov registration status and exclusions, then request the separately available entity integrity information. Report the source, retrieval date, entity match, and any access restrictions or missing records. Present the evidence and unresolved gaps without making a responsibility determination.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov · This prompt needs the Local full SAM.gov edition for live API or detailed certification/integrity fields.

Historical contract activity by fiscal year

Using the confirmed recipient UEI for [COMPANY], retrieve USAspending dated contract transactions for [START FY] through [END FY], one fiscal year at a time. Report query coverage, transaction and distinct-award counts, and the earliest returned action date. Page within a stated scope. Distinguish reporting gaps, unsupported periods and empty responses; the earliest returned action is not proof of the company's first federal award.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Build a teaming shortlist

Build a teaming shortlist from active SAM.gov registrants in [STATE] with NAICS [NAICS] anywhere on their records and [SOCIOECONOMIC STATUS]. Use the server's appropriate business-type or SBA-certification filter. Report the total count and returned page size, paginate within the agreed scope, and deduplicate by UEI. Show each firm's name, UEI, relevant NAICS, registration expiration, and returned certification status and dates. Flag missing evidence and explain search coverage.
If Hosted SAM.gov is connected, report the source file name and date. Entity records are monthly snapshots; opted-out entities are not included in the hosted public mirror. Confirm current registration and material exclusion findings on SAM.gov before relying on them.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov · Hosted SAM.gov supplies monthly public registration records, certification codes, and any listed exit dates; entry dates and live details require Local full.

Understand a market

Keep fiscal years, amount fields, and geography consistent when comparing spending.

Who an agency pays under your code

Show [AGENCY]'s USAspending contract obligations under NAICS [NAICS] for the most recently completed fiscal year. State the exact fiscal-year dates, show the available sub-agency breakdown, and list the top ten recipients. Distinguish a single returned category from complete organizational detail and identify any source or filter limitations.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Where the work is, by state

Show federal contract obligations under NAICS [NAICS] by place-of-performance state for the most recently completed fiscal year. State the exact period and geography basis, sort the states by amount, and separate unknown locations. Do not describe recipient headquarters spending as the location where work is performed.

Required MCPs: USAspending

An agency's set-aside share

Estimate the share of [AGENCY]'s contract obligations under NAICS [NAICS] associated with small-business set-aside codes over the last two years. Use matching periods and award filters for numerator and denominator, list the codes included, and show the calculation. Keep unknown classifications separate where the source allows. Explain that set-aside coding is not the same measure as all awards to small businesses.

Required MCPs: USAspending

The five-year trend

Show [AGENCY]'s USAspending contract obligations under NAICS [NAICS] for the last five completed fiscal years. Give the exact fiscal years, amounts, year-over-year changes, and a short explanation of the trend. Keep any current partial fiscal year separate. Treat past obligations as market context rather than a forecast of future opportunities.

Required MCPs: USAspending

The big vehicles

Identify large IDVs under NAICS [NAICS] in USAspending, stating the amount field and period used for ranking. For the vehicle I select, retrieve its detail and linked child awards. Use additional searches only when their relationship to the vehicle can be supported. Report missing links or incomplete coverage; do not conclude that an active vehicle has no orders solely from an empty response.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Find the right codes

Use source references for NAICS, PSC, and size-standard research.

Find your NAICS

What NAICS code covers [BUSINESS ACTIVITY]? Give me the code and the closest alternates so I do not file under the wrong one.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Retrieve the size standard

Use the eCFR MCP to retrieve the currently available size-standard table in 13 CFR 121.201 for NAICS [CODE]. Return the matching industry, dollar or employee threshold, and relevant exceptions or footnotes, with the source date and citation. If the table, row, or notes cannot be retrieved completely, state that limitation and do not supply a threshold from memory.

Required MCPs: eCFR

Find your PSC

Find PSC codes for [SERVICE AND DELIVERY MODEL], with official names. Check current or retired status in the official PSC manual; mark unverified status unknown. Separate codes for current opportunities from legacy codes for award history.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Decode a PSC

Use the available PSC reference tools to retrieve PSC [CODE], its official description, and related categories. Report active or retired status only if the returned reference explicitly provides it. If status or a detailed definition is unavailable, identify that gap instead of inferring it from a missing search result.

Required MCPs: USAspending

Codes to opportunities, one chain

Find the PSC code for [SERVICE], then search SAM.gov opportunities under that exact code with a response deadline still open. Codes first, opportunities second, one chain.

Required MCPs: SAM.gov + USAspending

Compare labor rates

CALC+ rates are awarded ceilings. Compare like categories and disclose differences.

Find the right labor category title

I do not know GSA's exact labor category title for [ROLE]. Show me the closest matching titles with how many rate records each carries, so I search the right string.

Required MCPs: GSA CALC+

The rate distribution

Show CALC+ ceiling-rate distributions for labor-category titles matching [LABOR CATEGORY]. Identify the exact titles, filters, record count, and available percentile or summary statistics. Compare relevant education and experience groups using supported filters. Explain whether results combine multiple titles, and do not present calculated precision beyond what the source supports.

Required MCPs: GSA CALC+

A company's rate card

Pull [COMPANY]'s GSA rate card and every row whose labor category contains [KEYWORD]. Ask for the total category count and page through until you have every row; the card reports which rows came back and whether more remain. There is no server-side vendor-plus-keyword search, so the keyword screen happens on the rows you fetched.

Required MCPs: GSA CALC+

Where does this rate sit?

Position $[RATE]/hr for [LABOR CATEGORY] against relevant awarded CALC+ ceiling-rate distributions. Show the comparison set, percentile band, geography, education and experience differences, and data limitations. Do not call the rate defensible, reasonable, fair, or acceptable; leave that determination to the authorized official.

Required MCPs: GSA CALC+

Research wages

BLS wages describe a labor-market input. Show the occupation, location, and data year.

What the labor earns

Use BLS OEWS to find median and 75th-percentile annual wages for [OCCUPATION] in [METRO AREA]. Confirm the available data year, SOC code, and geographic match first. Report missing, suppressed, or unavailable figures explicitly, along with the source period; do not silently substitute a different year or location.

Required MCPs: BLS OEWS

Metro versus metro

Compare wages for [OCCUPATION] across [METRO 1] and [METRO 2], then pull the national median separately as the baseline. I am deciding where a position can realistically be staffed.

Required MCPs: BLS OEWS

Raw wage, your burden math

Give me the raw BLS wage for [OCCUPATION] in [METRO], median and 10th and 90th percentile, current data year, with no loaded-rate estimate attached. The burden math is mine.

Required MCPs: BLS OEWS

Market floor against awarded ceiling

Compare the BLS OEWS wage for [OCCUPATION] in [METRO] with CALC+ ceiling rates for a closely matched labor category. Keep raw wages and fully burdened ceiling rates distinct. If showing a burdened-wage scenario, use [BURDEN MULTIPLIER] or ask me to supply it, and show the formula. Explain occupation, experience, geography, and pricing-basis differences.

Required MCPs: GSA CALC+ + BLS OEWS

The whole staffing picture

Compare median wages for [OCCUPATION 1], [OCCUPATION 2], and [OCCUPATION 3] side by side in [METRO]. I am pricing a mixed labor category task order and want the whole staffing picture in one table, not separate lookups.

Required MCPs: BLS OEWS

Estimate travel

Name the location and travel dates before using lodging or M&IE rates.

Lodging and M&IE

Retrieve GSA lodging and M&IE rates for [CITY, STATE] in [FISCAL YEAR]. Show seasonal lodging changes, the matched locality, and the rate period. Identify an unmatched or fallback locality clearly before using the rates in an estimate.

Required MCPs: GSA Per Diem

Price a trip

Estimate per-traveler lodging and M&IE for [N] nights in [CITY, STATE] during [MONTH, YEAR]. Use the matching fiscal-year rates, identify the locality, show the daily components, and apply the tool's first/last-day M&IE treatment explicitly. State the assumed travel days and exclude airfare and other expenses unless separately supplied. Ask for a date if it is missing instead of silently pricing another season.

Required MCPs: GSA Per Diem

The ZIP fallback

Look up GSA per diem for ZIP [ZIP] in [FISCAL YEAR]. Report the locality actually returned, lodging seasonality, and M&IE. If the ZIP lookup also falls back or fails to match, keep that uncertainty visible rather than treating the location as confirmed.

Required MCPs: GSA Per Diem

Read the regulations

Retrieve the relevant codified text and its source date; check completeness before quoting.

The FAR as it reads today

Retrieve FAR [CITATION] using the eCFR MCP's latest available Title 48 date. Quote the relevant text and provide the citation and source date. Inspect its version history and compare relevant revisions before calling a change substantive; distinguish publication, amendment, effective, and retrieval dates when the source supplies them.

Required MCPs: eCFR

What changed in a FAR part

Find sections in FAR Part [PART] with eCFR version changes in the last year, then compare before and after section by section for the changes relevant to [TOPIC]. State the dates used and distinguish substantive wording changes from editorial or structural changes. Identify incomplete comparisons rather than claiming the entire part was reviewed.

Required MCPs: eCFR

Chase a FAR definition

Find the FAR definition of [TERM] using the eCFR MCP. Retrieve the relevant section or complete matching definition, including numbered subparagraphs and exceptions. Give the citation and source date. If a large section such as FAR 2.101 is truncated, identify the missing portion and do not present a partial definition as complete.

Required MCPs: eCFR

Follow published changes

Separate direct rulemaking documents from related mentions and background notices.

What's moving on a topic

Search Federal Register documents on [TOPIC] from the last 6 months across all document types, ordered by relevance; the live items are often notices and RFIs, not just proposed rules. For anything with an open comment period, give me the deadline.

Required MCPs: Federal Register

Which agencies are moving

Count Federal Register documents on [TOPIC] by agency for the last twelve months using the available facet tools. State the date range, search terms, document types, and returned counts. Use the result to choose which agencies to examine next; a count alone does not indicate the significance of a policy change.

Required MCPs: Federal Register

Track a FAR case

Trace FAR Case [NUMBER] through Federal Register documents in date order. Separate documents directly addressing the case from Unified Agenda entries or other notices that merely mention it. Show proposed, final, withdrawn, and effective-date information only where supported, with source links and any gaps in the retrieved history.

Required MCPs: Federal Register

Explore dockets and comments

Make the docket, deadline, sample, and supporting documents clear.

Open for comment right now

What is open for comment right now on [TOPIC]? Use the Federal Register's open comment periods with a term filter for this one; the Regulations.gov version filters by agency only. Give me the docket ID, or the document number when a notice carries no docket, and the closing date.

Required MCPs: Federal Register

The real FAR and DFARS pipeline

Find FAR and DFARS proposed rules with open comment periods using the Regulations.gov MCP's available agency and document filters. Check the relevant FAR and DARS agency codes, then distinguish actual proposed rule changes from routine information-collection notices. Return the docket or document ID, title, closing date, source link, and any filter or coverage limitations.

Required MCPs: Regulations.gov

Read organizational comments in a docket

For docket [DOCKET ID], find organizational comments using terms such as association, chamber, coalition, or institute. Group them by the document commented on. Read full comment text or attachments before summarizing positions, and cite each source. If attachments are unreadable, say so rather than infer positions from snippets. Explain the keyword selection; it is not all comments or a measure of consensus.

Required MCPs: Regulations.gov

FAR Overhaul and deviations

Keep codified text, FAR Overhaul model text, and agency deviations separate, with source dates.

Find the model text and the agency's posted deviation

Use the Acquisition.gov MCP to retrieve the FAR Overhaul model text for FAR Part [PART] and find posted deviations for [AGENCY] and that part. Retrieve the relevant indexed deviation documents. Report source links, retrieval dates, and any stated effective dates or applicability language, with PDF page references. Keep the model text separate from the agency's documented action, and clearly identify missing or conflicting evidence. Do not decide which rule governs my procurement.

Required MCPs: Acquisition.gov

Compare codified text, model text, and an agency deviation

Compare the current codified text for FAR [CITATION] using eCFR with the relevant FAR Overhaul model part and [AGENCY]'s posted deviation using Acquisition.gov. Show the three sources separately, cite exact sections or PDF pages, and explain the differences. Include retrieval dates and document-stated dates. Do not treat model text as agency adoption or infer applicability from a filename.

Required MCPs: eCFR + Acquisition.gov